

Agency Vetting Scorecard

25-Question Evaluation Tool — Score Any Agency Before You Sign

The wrong agency costs you budget, momentum, and six months you cannot get back. Score each agency you are evaluating on the questions below (0 = red flag, 1 = weak, 2 = acceptable, 3 = strong), then compare totals. Any single red-flag trigger should end the conversation regardless of total score.

SECTION A
—
THE TEAM (
score
each
0–3)

Q1.
Who specifically will work on our account, and what is their experience?

Red
flag: they cannot or will not name the actual team members.

Q2.
How many accounts does each strategist manage at once?

Red
flag: more than 10–12 accounts per strategist.

Q3.
Will we
speak
to the
people
doing
the
work,
or only
an acco
unt man
ager?

Q4.
What ha
ppens
if our
main
contact
leaves
the age
ncy?

Q5.
Are spe
cialists
in-
house
or subc
ontracte
d?

**SECTI
ON B
— PR
OOF (
score
each
0–3)**

Q6.
Can
you
show
case
studies
from
clients
in or
near
our indu
stry?

Red
flag: no
case
studies
with real
performa
nce
numbers.

Q7.
Can we
speak
to two
current
clients
as refer
ences?

Q8.
What
results
did
your
last
three
clients
in our
budget
range a
chieve?

Q9.
Can
you
show
work
you con
sider a
failure,
and
what
you lear
ned?

Strong
agencies
answer
this
honestly.
Evasion
is a
signal.

Q10.
How
long
does
your av
erage
client
stay
with
you?

Red
flag:
average
retention
under 12
months.

**SECTI
ON C
— PR
OCES
S (sco
re
each
0–3)**

Q11.
What
does

your discovery process look like before strategy is set?

Red
flag: guaranteed results promised before any discovery.

Q12. What happens in the first 30 days of the engagement?

Q13. How do you decide what to prioritize each month?

Q14. Who owns the ad accounts, analytics, and creative

assets?
Red
flag: the agency owns accounts you would lose on

exit.

Q15.
How do
you
handle
a strate
gy that
is not w
orking?

SECTION D — REPORTING (score each 0–3)

Q16.
What metrics do you report on, and how often?

Red flag: reports built on impressions and reach with no revenue or lead metrics.

Q17.
Can we see a sample monthly report?

Q18.
Do we get live dashboard access or only monthly PDFs?

Q19.
How do you attribute

leads
and
sales
to your
work?

Q20.
What
does "s
uccess"
look
like at
90
days?
At 12 m
onths?

**SECTI
ON E
— CO
NTRA
CT TE
RMS (
score
each
0–3)**

Q21.
What is
the mini
mum co
ntract
length?
Red
flag: 12-
month
lock-in
with no p
erforman
ce
clause.

Q22.
What is
the
notice
period
to exit,
and
what
do we

keep?

Q23.
Are there performance clauses or guarantees, and what triggers them?

Q24.
What is NOT included in the quoted retainer?

Red flag: vague scope that invites surprise invoices.

Q25.
What do you need from us to succeed?

Strong agencies have clear client-side requirements. "Nothing, we handle everything" is a sales line.

**SCOR
ING G
UIDE**

**1.
60–
75
poi
nts**

Strong ca
ndidate.
Check ref
erences,
then
negotiate
terms.

**2.
45–
59
poi
nts**

Possible
fit with re
servation
s. Revisit
the weak
sections
before
deciding.

**3.
Below
45
poi
nts**

Walk
away.
The
gaps will
surface
as
problems
within
the first
quarter.

**4.
Any
red**

flag
End
the conver-
sation re-
gardless
of total
score.

COMPARISON SHEET

Agency 1 — Name / Total Score	Agency 2 — Name / Total Score	Agency 3 — Name / Total Score	Red Flags Noted	Decision & Date:
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